

MADHYA PRADESH

AN EMERGING HIGHER EDUCATION HUB

The years gone by have witnessed some revolutionary changes in the field of higher education in the country. The most important change is that now higher education is a major contributor to the economy. With India striding fast to become a knowledge society, higher education is no longer restricted to a handful rich and so called higher sections of society. Now it is accessible to even the poorest of the poor. With banks advancing education loan poverty of higher is no longer a hurdle to pursue higher education.



SHRI SHIVRAJ SINGH CHAUHAN
HON'BLE CHIEF MINISTER

Even more important factor is that now almost all sections of society are growing more and more aware about importance and need of quality higher education. Even middle class and lower middle class people, who used to be keen on buying houses, now prefer to invest in higher education of their children. The latter are also keen to keep catch up with the advanced world. Besides, the returns on quality higher education are so good that the youth want to spare nothing to excel in it.

One would thus see that the youth of India is quite passionate to make a mark at international level by virtue of knowledge and professional expertise. This is nothing but a revolution in education. How can Madhya Pradesh, centrally located in the country, be intact from this revolution? In view of the above said facts, it becomes the responsibility of the state government to ensure quality education and better educational facilities to the youth. Over the years the Madhya Pradesh government has lived up to this expectation. As a result now Madhya Pradesh is poised to emerge as a higher education hub. This is well brought out by the fact that at the Global Investors Summit held at Indore MoUs were signed for twelve private universities in the state.

Action is being taken to set up a Special Education Zone (S.Ed.Z) in the form of Knowledge City at Bhopal for which 635 acre of land has already been allotted by the government. The Knowledge City would house reputed medical, engineering and other colleges on a single premises for which they would be given concessions.

The state government has paid special attention to improvement of quality of higher education over the last four years. The Private University Act has been enacted to facilitate establishment of private universities by internationally renowned and reputed educational institutions in the state. A Private University Regulatory Commission has been constituted. This would also enable the institutions to offer courses in tune with the requirements created by industrialization and globalization. This is a good initiative to channelise the energy of private sector for public welfare. One private university has already been opened and L.O.I. has been issued for another seven universities. Seven

